Clinical Trials Office Unit (CTO)

Service Provider for Investigator Initiated Cancer Trials

Karolinska Institutet

KAROLINSKA UNIVERSITY HOSPITAL

Karolinska Comprehensive Cancer Center

Department of Clinical Cancer Studies

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Head of Department
Kristina Sonnevi

Medical Lead
Luigi De Petris - Oncology
Maria Creignou- Hematology

Economic controller

Cancer Study Unit

Solna
Johanna Vernersson
(Head of Unit)

Coordination of cancer trials in Solna

24 Research Nurses
6 Sample coordinators

Huddinge
Sofie Sibia
(Head of Unit)

Coordination of Cancer trials in Huddinge

16 Research Nurses
8 Sample coordinators

Clinical Trials Office

Semra Öz
(Head of Unit)

Office for academic sponsor trials

11 Clinical Research Managers (CRM) incl Datamanager

Phase 1 Unit

Solna
Caroline Brav
(Head of Unit)

FiH/Phase 1-trials in Solna
8 Research Nurses
2 Sample coordinators

Huddinge
Sofie Sibia
(Head of Unit)

FiH/Phase 1 cancer and non-cancer diagnosis & healthy volunteers
4 Research Nurses
1 Sample coordinators

6 Phase 1-Investigators (3 FTE)

Clinical Trials Office

Unit & Function

Est: 2002

Unit

- Unit within Karolinska University Hospital supporting non-commercial, academic clinical drug trials and studies.
- Over 20 years of experience supporting investigators and researchers at Karolinska and Karolinska Institutet
- Also provides assistance to other hospitals when resources allow

Scope and Function

- Comprehensive support for clinical trials: regulatory, project, monitoring, data, and safety services
- Expertise across multiple therapeutic areas – oncology, hematology, neurology, pediatrics, and more
- Supports studies in all phases (I–IV), projects including First-in-Human and advanced cell therapy studies ATMP
- National and international projects

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Clinical Trials Office

Service Provider

- Study Protocols – Design, writing, and consent documentation. In an advisory capacity helping with study design
- Regulatory Support – Applications via CTIS (MPA & Ethics Authority)
- Project Management – Agreements, meetings, documentation, TMF
- Monitoring – GCP-compliant, on-site (Sweden) or remote
- Data Management – Database setup, collection, analysis
- Safety Reporting – Adverse events & ASR preparation
- Training & Regulatory Advisory – For managers and research support units at Karolinska
- Assist in developing the study budget when applying for grants
- Responsible for distributing site payments according to the criteria established for data entry

Clinical Trials Office

Competence & Capabilities

- Diverse, expert Clinical Trial Managers
  Backgrounds: Biomedicine (PhD), Molecular Biology (PhD), Chemistry (PhD), Pharmacy, Nursing (lic), Data Management
- Complementary expertise
- Trial Managers also serve as Monitors
- Close collaboration with Sponsor representative & Research group
- Ensures regulatory compliance and oversight
- Single point of contact for studies
- Coordination of contracts, legal, and financial matters
- Broad expertise across therapeutic areas
- Experience across a broad range of early clinical trials
  - Complex immunotherapy
  - Vaccines
  - Small molecules
  - PET-tracers and PET-ligands
  - ATMP
  - TCR, CAR-T, adoptive T-cell therapy

Budgeting for a Clinical Study

- Budgeting for a clinical study — a key factor for both feasibility and success

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Why budgeting matters

- Ensures feasibility and study completion
- Prevents delays and interruptions
- Supports high-quality data
- Reduces financial risk

Underestimating costs is a common cause of study failure

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When to start budgeting

- During study design
- While drafting the protocol
- When exploring funding

Budget and protocol must be aligned

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Main cost categories

- Personnel
- Study procedures
- Administrative costs

Hidden and underestimated cost

- Recruitment

(*reimbursment to trial site per included patient incl CT/DT, blood samples)*

- Staff training
- Monitoring & audits
- Central lab analysis / Translational studyanalysis
- Data storage & archiving
- Insurance

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Small recurring costs accumulate

International studies

- Monitoring across countries
- Travel & coordination
- Regulatory applications
- Country-specific fees (e.g., Denmark annual fee)

Higher complexity and cost

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Site-specific and overhead considerations

- Costs vary by department and infrastructures
- Infrastructure differences
- Overhead: KI ~24%, Karolinska ~15%

Overhead must be included early to avoid gaps.

Study drug & pharmacy

- Drug cost
- Preparation & storage
- Pharmacy handling
- Pharmacy agreements
- Drug distribution across country/countries (Tamro, Oriola)

Each site needs a pharmacy agreement in drug trials

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Funding sources in academic trials

- Research grants

Sjöbergsstiftelsen, Vetenskapsrådet, Cancerfonden, Barncancerfonden, Radiumhemmetsforskningsfonder

- Industry collaborations
- Internal funding

Many funders require annual reporting

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Common challanges

- Underestimating workload
- Hidden costs
- Slow recruitment
- Protocol amendments

Role of Clinical Trials Office

- Budget planning & financial management
- Contract management
- Site payments
- Pharmacy agreements & invoices
- Build flexibility into the budget

Supporting the sponsor throughout the study

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Key take aways

- Start early
- Align with study design
- Include hidden & international costs
- Plan for overhead & pharmacy

Follow the budget continuously

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20	Betalningsplan										TOTALT
21	**Co-ordination Björn Wallin**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026**	**2027**	**2028**	**2029**	**2030**	**2031**	**2032**	
22	study co-ordination Björn Wallin (20%) (Hourly rate p	460 000	460 000	460 000	460 000	460 000	460 000	460 000	460 000	460 000	
23	sponsor eCRF- development Björn Wallin (Hourly rat	300 000									
24	**Sum co-ordination**	**760 000**	**460 000**	**460 000**	**460 000**	**460 000**	**460 000**	**460 000**	**460 000**	**460 000**	
25											
26	**Application cost + Insurance**	**2 024**	**2 025**	**2 026**	**2 027**	**2 028**	**2 029**	**2 030**	**2 031**	**2 032**	
27	Sweden, CTIS (Medical product agency + Ethics cor	56 000									
28	Norway, CTIS (Medical product agency + Ethics com	56 000									
29	Finland, CTIS (Medical product agency + Ethics com	56 000									
30	Iceland, CTIS (Medical product agency + Ethics com	56 000									
31	Danmark, CTIS (Medical product agency + Ethics co	56 000									
32	Amendments		15 200	15 200	15 200	15 200	15 200	15 200	15 200	15 200	
33	Biobank- regional multicenter Sweden + ammendme	12 500	6 250								
34	**Sum applications and insurance cost**	**292 500**	**21 450**	**15 200**	**15 200**	**15 200**	**15 200**	**15 200**	**15 200**	**15 200**	
35											
36	**Datamanager / eCRF**	**2 024**	**2 025**	**2 026**	**2 027**	**2 028**	**2 029**	**2 030**	**2 031**	**2 032**	
37	OpenClinca eCRF setup (Arhus Denmark)	480 000	100 000								
38	Datamanagement (Hourly rate 1175 SEK excl OH)		48 750	48 750	48 750	48 750	48 750	48 750	48 750	48 750	
39	OpenClinica licens cost/per year		10 000	10 000	10 000	10 000	10 000	10 000	10 000	10 000	
40	Randomization ALEA - setup price	200 000									
41	ALEA licens cost /per year		5 000	5 000	5 000						
42	Datamanagement ALEA (hourly rate 1175 sek excl OH)		18 000	18 000	18 000						
43	**Sum database incl datamanagement**	**680 000**	**181 750**	**81 750**	**81 750**	**58 750**	**58 750**	**58 750**	**58 750**	**58 750**	
44											
45	**Statistician**	**2 024**	**2 025**	**2 026**	**2 027**	**2 028**	**2 029**	**2 030**	**2 031**	**2 032**	
46	Study protocol work - design, power calculation, stat	91 250									
47	statistics, work on an ongoing basis, Final report and reporting (Hourly rate 1250 SEK excl OH)					41 250				191 250	
48	**Sum statistician**	**91 250**				**41 250**				**191 250**	

0	**Study coordinator Clinical Trials Office Kar**										
1	Application work										
2	Amendment work - if applicable										
3	Set up pharmacy agreement										
4	Set up Trial Masterfile TMF, including loading of the study + update										
5	Establish site agreement + disbursement site										
6	Set up a biobank application - MTA										
7	Contact with Sweden sites and other ongoing study										
8	Study coordination Norway, start-up, agreements, pharmacies										
9	Study coordination Finland, start-up, agreements, pharmacies										
0	Study coordination Denmark, start-up, agreements, pharmacies										
1	Study coordination Iceland, start-up, agreements, pharmacies										
2	**Sum study coordination**										
3											
4	**PET scan and central review of pathology**										
5	Study specific PET scan 25500 kr/st x 2 per patient										
6	Pathology review cost (hourly rate 2100 SEK)										
7	Transport costs (posting samples and reports) all countries		45 200	45 200	45 200	45 200	45 200	45 200			
8	Sampling material translational samples		18 000	18 000	18 000	18 000	18 000	18 000			
9	**Sum PET scan and central review of pathol**	**13 770 000**	**113 200**	**113 200**	**113 200**	**113 200**	**113 200**	**113 200**	**50 000**		**14 499 200**
0											
1	**Investigational drug**	**2 024**	**2 025**	**2 026**	**2 027**	**2 028**	**2 029**	**2 030**	**2 031**	**2 032**	
2	Pharmacy agrement set up cost 24 sites x 20.000kr	480 000									
3	Phamacy reimbursment Lenalidomide cost Finland a	100 000	100 000								
4	Pharmacovigilance (incl SUSAR and SAE registratior	25 000	15 000	15 000	15 000	15 000	15 000	15 000	15 000	15 000	
5	Annual safety report (Hourly rate 1175SEK)	24 375	48 750	48 750	24 375	24 375	24 375	24 375	24 375	24 375	
6	**Sum Investigational drug**	**629 375**	**163 750**	**63 750**	**39 375**	**39 375**	**39 375**	**39 375**	**39 375**	**39 375**	**1 093 125**
7											
8	**Monitoring incl travel cost. 2 visit per cente**	**2 024**	**2 025**	**2 026**	**2 027**	**2 028**	**2 029**	**2 030**	**2 031**	**2 032**	
9	Monitoring Sweden 8 center (Hourly rate 1175 SEK)	195 000	331 500	273 000	273 000	273 000	273 000	273 000	273 000	273 000	**2 437 500**
0	Monitoring Norway 5 center	195 000	195 000	195 000	195 000	146 250	146 250	146 250	146 250	146 250	
1	Monitoring Finland 5 center	195 000	195 000	195 000	195 000	146 250	146 250	146 250	146 250	146 250	
2	Monitoring Denmark 5 center	195 000	195 000	195 000	195 000	146 250	146 250	146 250	146 250	146 250	
3	Monitoring Iceland 1 center	48 750	48 750	48 750	48 750	24 375	24 375	24 375	24 375	24 375	
4	**Sum monitorering**	**828 750**	**965 250**	**906 750**	**906 750**	**736 125**	**736 125**	**736 125**	**736 125**	**736 125**	**7 288 125**
5	**Totalt**										
6											
7	**Patient fee, site compensation 75000 SEK**	**All study specific time for research nurse and PI, pharmcy cost Rituximab+ Lenolidomide, study specific moment, tumor samples, translationell b**									**20 250 000**
8	**Summary all post A16- A78, SEK**										**52 224 050**
9	**Karolinska overhead 15% SEK (K18,K37, K42,K56,K73**										**1 666 613**
0	**Total Summary inkl. Overhead, SEK**										**53 890 663**

Team

KCTO Clinical Trials Office

Clinical Trial Managers CRM
Katja Tobin
Katja Wiklund
Réka Conrad
Fihima Yusuf
Sara Göransson
Mats Hellstöm
Åsa Kolterud
Gustav Colldén

Clinical Research Associate CRA
Johanna Andlin 1/5-26

Datamanager
Claudia Maes
Yvonne Larsen
Mats Hellström
Rebecca Sjöberg 1/6-26

Financial Team
Marika Borge
Mimmi Gustavsson

Thank you!

Contact: semra.oz-baloglu@regionstockholm.se

Clinical Trials Office

DEPARTMENT OF CLINICAL CANCER STUDIES

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